

Yemen

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** May 22, 1990 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red, white and black, are pan-Arab colors



The flag adopted for the united state was based on the common tricolor of former flags of North and South Yemen

Asia



Yemen was originally two countries, the Kingdom of Yemen, in the north, and the British Aden Protectorate in the south. The two united in 1990.

The first flag of the Yemen, used while the Imams were in power, was red, with a white sword placed horizontally in the center and five white stars representing the five duties of a devout Muslim. Yemen was originally two countries, each having their own flag.

SOUTH YEMEN

Formally the British Aden Protectorate, the flag of the People's Democratic Republic of Yemen was modeled on the Egyptian pan-Arab flag. It was a red, white, and black tricolor and it bore a blue triangle, representing the Yemeni people in the hoist, while a red star represented the Socialist ruling party.

NORTH YEMEN

The flag of the Yemen Arab Republic, formally the Kingdom of Yemen, was also modeled on the Egyptian flag. It was a red, white, and black tricolor, but it was simply charged with a single, five-pointed green star in a central white band, representing Arab unity.

A UNIFIED FLAG

When Yemen unified, the stars and the triangle were dropped, but the common elements of their flags—the pan-Arab red, white, and black stripes—were preserved for the united flag. The new flag's pattern suggests a compromise between the officially secular south and the Islamic north.